

# judges and kings summar

## JUDGES OF ISRAEL

### 1. Definition of a Judge (Person)

A judge was a leader raised by God to deliver, guide, and govern Israel before the establishment of kings.

 Judges 2:16

### 2. Definition of Judging (Action)

To judge means to make decisions, enforce justice, and correct wrongdoing according to God's law.

 Deuteronomy 16:18

### 3. Time Period of the Judges

After Joshua

Before King Saul

About 1400–1050 BC

 Judges 21:25

### 4. Form of Government Under the Judges

Israel was ruled as a theocracy — God was King, and judges were His representatives.

 Judges 8:23

## 5. Roles of the Judges

Judges served as:

Military deliverers

Spiritual leaders

Administrators of justice

Counselors to the people

## 6. Why God Appointed Judges

Israel repeatedly:

Disobeyed God

Worshipped idols

Faced oppression

God sent judges to:

Rescue Israel

Restore worship

Bring peace

 Judges 2:18

## 7. The Cycle of the Judges (Explained)

1. Israel sinned

2. God allowed oppression

3. Israel cried to God

4. God raised a judge

5. Peace followed

6. Judge died → cycle repeated

7. Examples of Judges

Deborah – Prophetess and leader (Judges 4–5)

Gideon – Victory through faith (Judges 6–7)

Samson – Great strength but weak self-control (Judges 13–16)

8. End of the Period of Judges

The period ended when Israel rejected God as King and demanded a human king.

 1 Samuel 8:5–7

## KINGS OF ISRAEL

1. Definition of a King

A king is a national ruler appointed to govern Israel under God's authority, not above God.

 Deuteronomy 17:14–20

## 2. Why Israel Wanted a King

Wanted to be like other nations

Desired visible leadership

Rejected God's direct rule

 1 Samuel 8:5

## 3. God's Warning About Kings

God warned that kings would:

Take sons to war

Tax the people

Abuse power

 1 Samuel 8:10–18

## 4. Qualities God Required in a King

A king must:

Be chosen by God

Obey God's law

Be humble

Avoid pride and greed

 Deuteronomy 17:18–20

## 5. Divine Role of a King

The king was to:

Lead the nation

Protect the people

Uphold justice

Encourage worship of God

 Psalm 72

## 6. Major Kings of Israel

King Saul – The Rejected King

First king

Disobedient

Lost God's favor

 1 Samuel 15:22

King David – A Man After God's Heart

Faithful leader

Sinned but repented

God valued his heart

 Psalm 51

King Solomon – Wisdom and Decline

Wisest king

Later disobedient

Kingdom weakened

 1 Kings 11

King Rehoboam – Division of the Kingdom

Son of Solomon

Ignored wisdom

Kingdom divided

 1 Kings 12

## 7. God's Authority Over Kings

God alone:

Raises kings

Removes kings

 Daniel 2:21

## 8. Lessons from the Kings

Obedience is greater than power

Wisdom must be guided by God

Pride leads to downfall

